



KISUMU COMMUNITY SERVICE AND TEAM BUILDING 2022 PROJECT

PROJECT THEME; FUTURE IN A MILLION TREES

DATE: 28th TO 30th OF OCTOBER

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT.

We take this opportunity to gratefully thank God for his protection before during and even after our activities during the planting and execution phase.

We acknowledge Egerton University administration for its continued support throughout the project period. Dedicating special thanks to Prof Mulwa, DVC administration planning, finance and planning. Also, the Dean of students' office as well the transport department.

Special thanks to the Kisumu County Government -environmental Department, - YGAK Green Organizationvolunteers for their involvement in the project success

We also appreciate Kenya medical training collage- Kisumu main campus, Joyland special school, Citam KIsumu , ACK shauri Moyo, The Mosque of Jesus Christ Son of Mary near star hospital.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

The Organization aims at offering a holistic approach for community development in Kenya based on the principle of empowerment, inclusion, self- determination and collective action towards the environment and climate action. This is achievable through research that underpins national programs to scale up the use of trees within farming systems in Kenya and then scale out success to relevant agroecological zones in Kenya. The Organization is dedicated to environmental improvements that foster a sustainable future and lead to social and economic empowerment in the community we do live. Our vision is to become the leading Non-Governmental Organization in promoting environmental conservation in Kenya

The Organization has been spearheading environmental conservation efforts with members across various faculties in the university. In various project the Organization has been partnering and receiving support from the institution for implementation of the projects. The Organization has been undertaking voluntary initiatives to promote sustainable development by conducting environmental workshops, capacity building, planting of trees, engaging in environmental clean-ups, visiting rehabilitation centers and children's homes among other activities which create a positive impact in society in general. The Organization has carried out various community service projects in various counties and towns including; Narok county, Mombasa County, Naivasha, Njoro sub-county, Kakamega County and now kisumu city.

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INTRODUCTION

Trees are an important part of our ecosystem. They play major roles in the existence of human life as a result, makes life more habitable and comfortable. The following are ways in which trees contribute to life on earth:

Social Benefits: Trees make life nicer. It has been shown that spending time among trees and green spaces reduces the amount of stress that we carry around with us in our daily lives. Hospital patients have been shown to recover from surgery more quickly when their hospital room offered a view of trees. Children have been shown to retain more of the information taught in schools if they spend some of their time outdoors in green spaces. Trees are often planted as living memorials or reminders of loved ones or to commemorate significant events in our lives

Communal Benefits: Even though you may own the trees on your property your neighbors may benefit from them as well. Through careful planning trees can be an asset to your entire community. Tree lined streets have a traffic calming effect, traffic moves more slowly and safely. Trees can be placed to screen unwanted views or noise from busy highways. Trees can complement the architecture or design of buildings or entire neighborhoods.

Environmental benefits: Trees reduce the urban heat island effect through evaporative cooling and reducing the amount of sunlight that reaches parking lots and buildings. This is especially true in areas with large impervious surfaces, such as parking lots of stores and industrial complexes. Trees improve our air quality by filtering harmful dust and pollutants such as ozone, carbon monoxide, and sulfur dioxide from the air we breathe. Trees give off oxygen that we need to breathe. Trees reduce the amount of storm water runoff, which reduces erosion and pollution in our waterways and may reduce the effects of flooding. Many species of wildlife depend on trees for habitat. Trees provide food, protection, and homes for many birds and mammals.

Economic Benefits: Well-placed trees can reduce your cooling costs in the summer by shading the south and west sides of your home. If deciduous trees are used, they will allow the sun to pass through and warm your home in the winter. Ever green trees on the north side of your home and shrubs around the foundation of your home can act as a windbreak to reduce the cooling effects of winter wind. The value of a well landscaped home with mature healthy trees can be as much as 10% higher than a similar home with no or little landscaping. (Topping will reduce the value of your trees) Some indirect economic benefits of trees are that if we reduce the energy, we use then utility companies will have less demand placed on the infrastructure, thus reducing operating costs which can be passed on to the consumer.

The County Government of Kisumu has committed to plant 40 million tree seedlings to help achieve the national afforestation agenda of planting at least 2 billion trees by 2022. To achieve this, the Organization joined the commitment by the Kisumu county government by involving in the planting of a total of 5000 tree seedlings within Kisumu town as from 28th to 30th October.

We started our project by planting trees at Kenya Medical Training Collage-Kisumu main campus, Joyland Secondary school, Citam School Kisumu, ACK Shauri Moyo ward, and finally at The Mosque of Jesus Christ son of Mary.

PROJECT OBJECTIVES

1. To plant 5,000 tree seedlings within Kisumu County
2. To develop and strengthen the skills of the volunteers
3. To sensitize the community on the importance of tree planting in environmental conservation
4. To promote the spirit of volunteerism.

PROJECT OUTPUT

- Plant 1000 trees
- Promote capacity building for 60 volunteers
- Perform Community service

Reinforce relationships between volunteers as well community and institutions.

PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

The Organization engaged students from different campuses and institutions as man power to make the project a success. The Organization partnered with Kisumu county Government, the Department of Environment, Kenya Medical Training Collage, Citam, Joyland Special school, ACK Shauri Moyo Ward and The Mosque of Jesus Christ Son of Mary in the execution of its plan.

Project Title	FUTURE IN A MILLION TREES	
Lead	YGAK GREEN CLUB	
Partner organizations	Club	Key Staff
	YGAK	Mr. Eliud Okumu
	Kenya Road Cross	Mr. Charles Elly Dr. Mildred Aduma
	Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology	Mr. Oscar Waswa
	Kisumu County Government	Mr. Benard Ojwang, Director Kisumu County Environment.
Project Purpose	To plant 5000 tree seedlings.	
Location	Kisumu City	
Start Date	28 th October, 2022	
End Date	30 th October, 2022	

PROJECT ACTIVITIES.

Kenya Medical Training Collage

The first tree planting activity on the first day was done at Kenya Medical Training Collage-main campus. We received very warm welcome from the Dean; **JAMES OKONG'O**, his deputy **ANDREW GAYA MALIT** and students. Representatives from Kisumu county government were also in attendance-Department of Environment. A total of 1000 tree seedlings were planted and watered as well.



KMTC Dean of students Mr. James Okong'o planting a tree at KMTC Kisumu main campus



KMTC Students and Youth for Green Action Kenya volunteers participating in tree planting

Joyland Secondary Special School.

Disability is not inability; Joyland Special Secondary School is a Public Secondary School, located in Winam near Kisumu Town, Kisumu East Constituency in Kisumu County. It is a school full of vibrant young individuals who are working towards realizing their full potential despite their challenges. this was the second place at which we involved in tree planting. A total of 1000 trees were also planted with students being fully engaged in the activity. The school environmental Organization led by their patron Madam CAROL were fully engaged in the activity and ensured its success. Moreover, the Organization took a step to empower and educate the students on the need to conserve the environment in their local area. The project sought to improve the environmental awareness of the students in joy land through a participatory approach in tree planting



Madam Carol, the patron to Joyland Environmental Organization planting tree seedling during the event



YGAK Volunteer and Joyland Special School students taking part in the tree planting activity

Citam Church -Kisumu.

A total of 1500 tree seedlings were planted at Citam Church. This activity was made possible and successful by involvement of the Red Cross Organization students in association with the volunteers. Mr. JARED- patron environmental Organization was in full supervision and ensured the success of the activity. Tree seedlings were successfully planted and watered. The initiative also impacted a positive change to student to draw their attention to care for the environment through caring for the trees planted in their school.

ACK Shauri Moyo Ward.

It is involved in religious activities. The main aim in their involvement in the project was to foster local community development as one of the key development principles. Community participation in tree planting activities in an effort to increase tree cover is a significant aspect in encouraging community interaction and improve community spirit, fostering a sense of ownership in communities. In addition, community participation in tree planting blocks possibilities of conflicts, rejection, increases acceptance and reduces incidences of vandalism. It also ensures sustainability of the exercise since the locals take the task to manage and protect the planted seedlings. The community mobilization strategy raised and formed a closer relationship of the Organization and the community to increase awareness with regard to the conservation of the environment. A total of 1500 tree seedlings were planted.

The Mosque of Jesus Christ son of Mary

The Muslim association named the planned mosque as Mosque of Jesus Christ Son of Mary to show goodwill to the local Christian community after the dispute. The construction of the mosque eventually finished and it was opened on 4 July 2021 in a ceremony officiated by executive member of the Muslim World League. This was the last place the Organization planted tree seedlings. A total of 1000 was planted. The activity was fully embraced by the students in the mosque. They felt the need to green their environment and as a result, the participative approach to tree planting encourages sustainability of the initiative as the students will take charge to care for the tree seedlings in the institution afterwards.



Abdi Yunus, Imam, The Mosque of Jesus Christ son of Mary, Shauri Moyo, Kisumu Planting tree seedling during the event and contributing positively to the environment

Mental health session and its connection to tree planting

Urban trees are an excellent remedy for improving our mental health and wellbeing. A growing body of research is showing that spending time around trees and nature reduces depression and anxiety, especially when combined with exercise. Time amongst trees decreases levels of the stress hormone cortisol and increases people's sense of wellbeing.

Being around trees tend to, Increase attentiveness and memory. Being around plants, whether at home or work, helps improve memory and attention span by 20 percent and can increase concentration. Therefore, a conclusion was arrived that trees connect to our mental well-being. The session was Graced by Kate Kaendi a psychologist and Mercy Ngina.



Isaac Wafula volunteer and a peer counselor enlightening Joyland secondary school students on the important of Environmental protection, conservation and preservation.



Miss Kate presentation during the Mental health workshop at KMTC theatre



Miss Ngina presentation during the Mental health and Environment workshop

Team Building

Team building is a process that helps a work group evolve into a cohesive unit. It was carried out during the process of the project to heighten their mood and rejuvenate their strengths' team members not only share expectations for accomplishing group tasks, but trust and support one another and respect one another's individual differences. The importance and main purpose of team building was to create a strong team through forming bonds and connections. Creating these bonds through team building was very beneficial to the volunteers. The benefits that the volunteers achieved include increased communication, planning skills, motivation, and collaboration.

CHALLENGES EXPERIENCED

- Inadequate space to plant the tree seedlings.
- Relatively fair reception with the locals.
- Language barrier.
- Late booking of facilities

CONCLUSION

Organization great focus is achieving sustainable development through meeting human development goals while sustaining the ability of natural systems to continue to provide the natural resources and ecosystem services upon which the economy and society depend. We understand this is a process and we focus on approaching it from local and regional levels with interest in robust economic and social progress with emphasis on the environment. Future in a Million Trees Initiative was worth an engaging, impactful and winning initiative that seeks to contribute to the environment positively.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Timely payments to allow booking of facilities in advance to ease project participation. Increase number of days to allow more activities done with regard to environmental conservation and preservation

APPENDICES

YGAKE GREEN ORGANIZATION CONCEPT NOTE.

Abstract

Planet Earth has a limited number of natural resources with fragile life-support systems, and thus, can carry a limited amount of burden. However, in the quest for economic progress and welfare, it is the environment that more often than not, gets compromised. Wide scale environment degradation is the consequent result of society's insatiable appetite for growth and development. There is an urgent need to balance growth and development without putting a burden on Mother Earth.

The Organization aims at offering a holistic approach for community development in Kenya based on the principle of empowerment, inclusion, self-determination and collective action towards the environment and climate action. This is achievable through research that underpins national programs to scale up the use of trees within farming systems in Kenya and then scale out success to relevant agro ecological zones in Kenya.

Mission statement.

We are dedicated to environmental improvements that foster a sustainable future and lead to social and economic empowerment in the community we do live.

Vision Statement.

A clean, healthy, safe and sustainable environment in Kenya.

OBJECTIVES

1. To promote conservation and sustainable use of environment in Kenya
2. To promote the culture of community philanthropy and volunteerism in Kenya

MAJOR THEMATIC AREAS

1. Environmental education, research, awareness and outreach
2. Conservation leadership

CORE VALUES

Open - We build trust through transparency and honesty; we're open to new ideas

Collaborative - We work with other Clubs, institutions of higher learning, corporate Clubs and individuals towards promoting environmental conservation and other SDGs Agile –We learn and innovate quickly to achieve goals and create impact.

Optimistic – We assume the best and are hopeful, encouraging and courageous

FOCUS

Our great focus is achieving sustainable development through meeting human development goals while sustaining the ability of natural systems to continue to provide the natural resources and ecosystem services upon which the economy and society depend. We understand this is a process and we focus on approaching it from local and regional levels with interest in robust economic and social progress with emphasis on the environment.

METHODOLOGY OF ACHIEVING OUR OBJECTIVES

Focus is given to outreach projects and activities in our communities that aim at greening the environment; tree planting, solid waste management, creating awareness

For all our established projects, we conduct follow up routines to ensure efficiency and long-term impacts

We empower community generated projects through partnership to ensure maximum incorporation of community players in operations

Philanthropy stands out as a main vehicle towards promoting the well-being of humanity and cultivate the spirit of one society and its ability to solve its challenges. This is a course we partake of

IMPACT

We have had successful projects focused on building community resilience towards addressing challenges posed by climate change. We carried out tree planting, youth leadership workshops, Environmental education in primary and high schools and stakeholder's meetings in the theme.

We have successfully planted approximately 10,000 trees in Narok, Nakuru, Mombasa Counties within two years of partnership, and collected approximately 5 tons of wastes in our different cleanup activities. Having been able to partner with different institutions, Clubs and individuals, has helped us realize our goals and objectives. The Organization so far has also approximately reached more than 100,000 people through our activities and on our social media platforms.

The organization is targeting to plant more than 100,000 trees yearly. We anticipate to further reach out to the less fortunate individuals or groups in our society through quarterly donations. The Organization targets to build strong partnership with institutions and other Clubs that promotes its agenda, as well as providing guidance

FUNDING

Sources of funds-

- Grants and project funds
- Donations and Gifts
- Members' contribution
- Income generating activities



